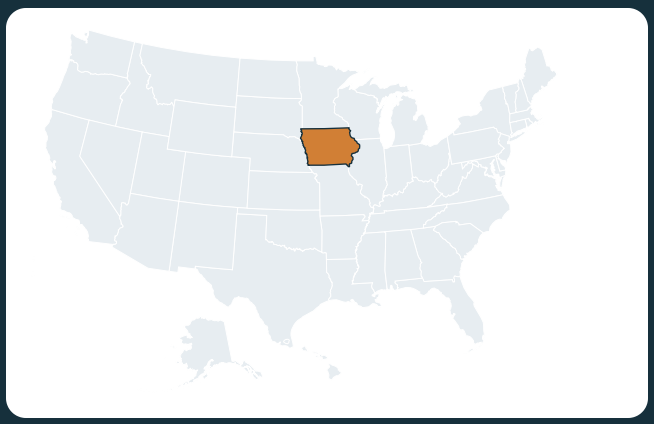
CYBER RESILIENCE · EXTERNAL ATTACK SURFACE

Iowa

How exposed are the state's critical access hospitals from the outside?

67.2% of 64 assessed hospital domains sit in an elevated risk band (Critical or High)

National: 78.3% · mean score 63.4 vs 68.5 national (−5.1)



64
hospital domains assessed in Iowa

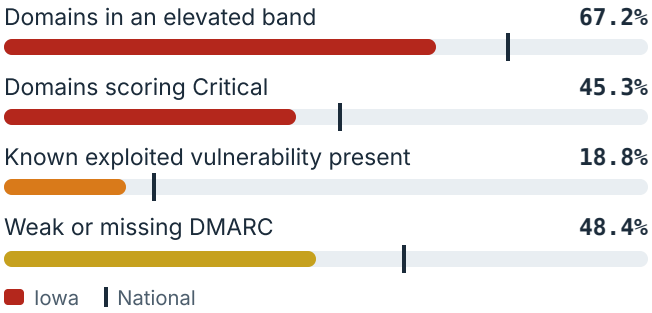
72
critical access hospitals located in the state

63.4
mean score · High band (0–100)

38th
most exposed of 42 reported states, by share elevated

Iowa against the national picture

Bars are Iowa; the black tick is the national figure across 977 domains.



How the 64 domains are distributed

Each domain is scored on its worst internet-facing machine.



Critical 29 · High 14 · Medium 11 · Low 10

DOMAINS WITH A FINDING IN	IA	US	DIFF
Vulnerabilities	41%	53%	-12 pts
Email authentication	59%	77%	-18 pts
Exposed services	64%	66%	-1 pts
Web application and DNS	88%	88%	-0 pts

THREE FIXES THAT MOVE THE NEEDLE

01
Enforce email authentication
Publish DMARC, read its reports, then move to p=reject. A DNS change: no purchase, no downtime. 48% of Iowa domains are weak or missing here.

02
Close admin and database doors
Remote Desktop, SSH and database ports should not answer the internet. Put them behind a VPN or turn them off.

03
Retire forgotten records
Remove DNS records that point at services you no longer run, and patch or replace outdated web libraries.

How this was measured. Passive observation of what each hospital publishes to the internet: DNS, certificates, open ports and public web pages. Nothing was logged into or exploited. Vulnerabilities are checked against the CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog and FIRST EPSS, current to 2026-09-08; part of the scan data is older, so read the figures as a floor. Domain counts are not hospital counts: one health-system domain can carry several hospitals. No hospital is named; figures are aggregate only.

SureShield with BorderHawk.
Check any critical access hospital's band, or test your email security for free, on the SureShield critical access hospital site.

SureShield analysis · generated 23 October 2026